Part I: Boston College

Academic year 2025–26

Official end-of-course evaluation reports for all three courses I taught.

Course	Level	Length	Page
Macroeconomics of Inequality (ECON3397)	Undergraduate elective	Full semester	2
Macroeconomic Theory I (ECON7750)	First-year PhD	Half semester	31
Monetary Economics II (ECON8862)	Second-year PhD	Half semester	56

BOSTON
COLLEGE

Fall 2025

ECON339701_2025FALL_Macroeconomics of Inequality - Lukas Freund

Created **Saturday, December 20, 2025**

Fall 2025 Course Evaluation Report for ECON339701_2025FALL_Macroeconomics of Inequality - Lukas Freund

Response Table

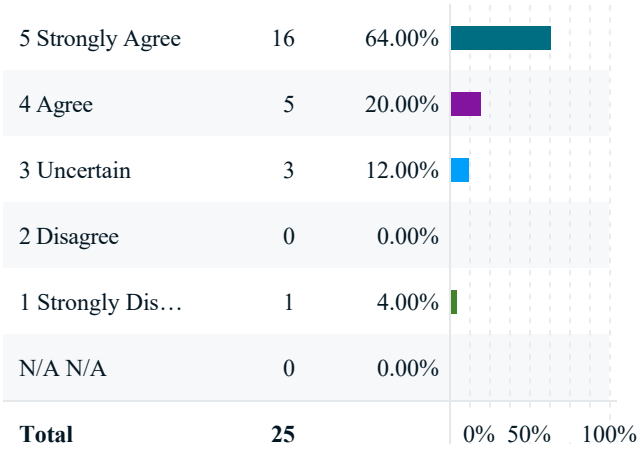
Raters	Students
Responded	26
Invited	30
Response Ratio	86.67%

Course Organization and Planning/ Course Design:

ECON339701_2025FALL_Macroeconomics of Inequality

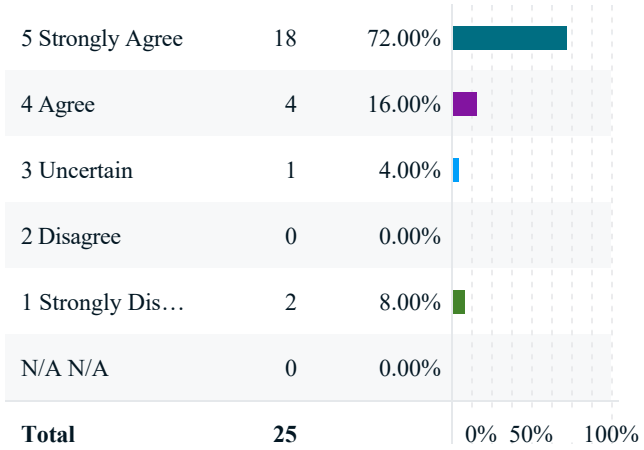
Distribution of Responses

1. The course was well organized.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.40
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.00

2. The learning objectives were clearly defined



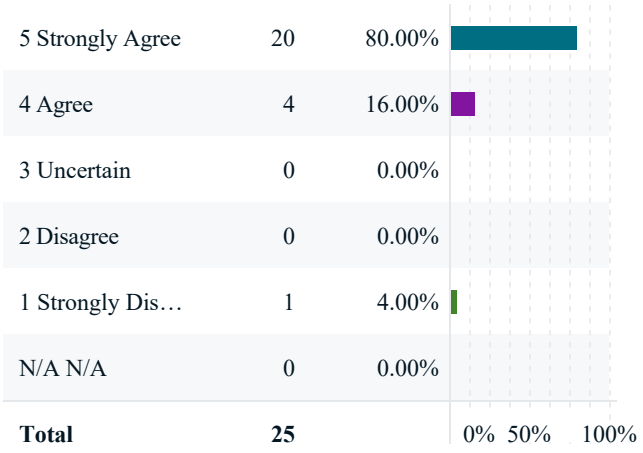
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.44
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.16

Course Difficulty and Workload:

ECON339701_2025FALL_Macroeconomics of Inequality

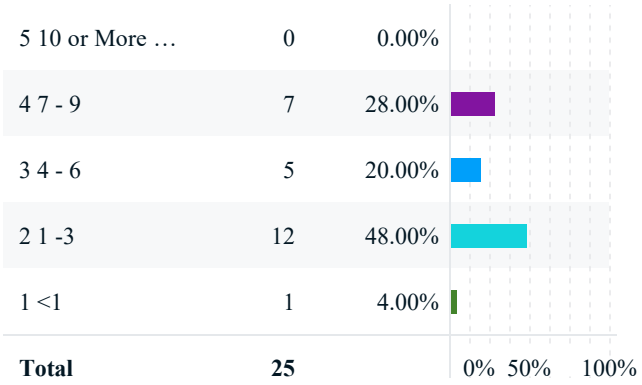
Distribution of Responses

The course was intellectually challenging.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.68
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.85

On average, how many hours per week outside of class do you devote for this course?



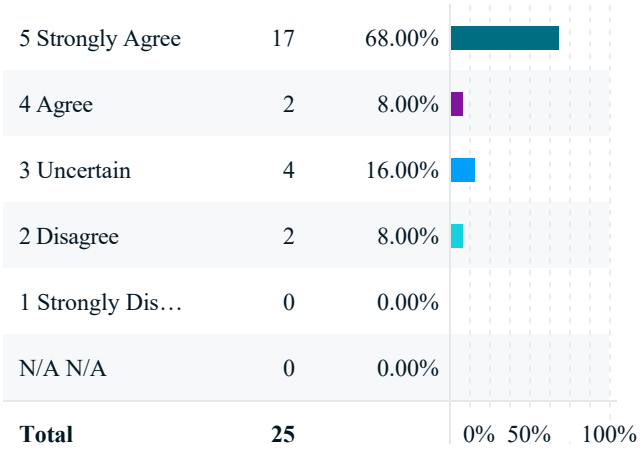
Statistics	Value
Response Count	25
Mean	2.72
Median	2.00
Mode	2
Standard Deviation	0.94

Course Learning Outcomes:

ECON339701_2025FALL_Macroeconomics of Inequality

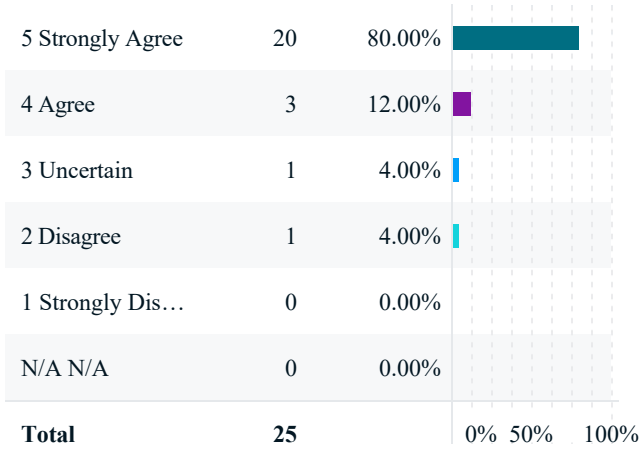
Distribution of Responses

1. Class attendance was necessary for learning the course material.



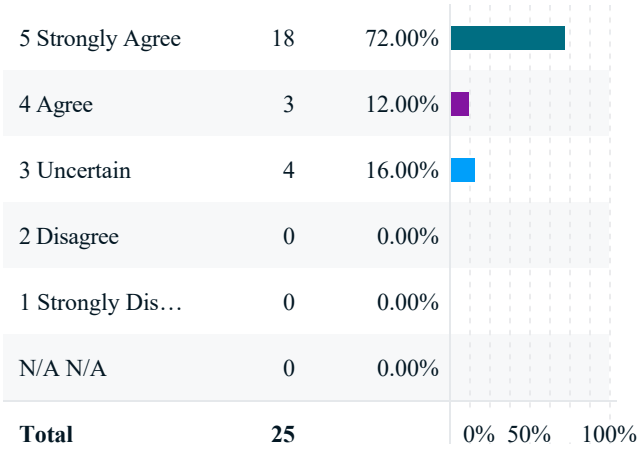
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.36
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.04

2. Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.



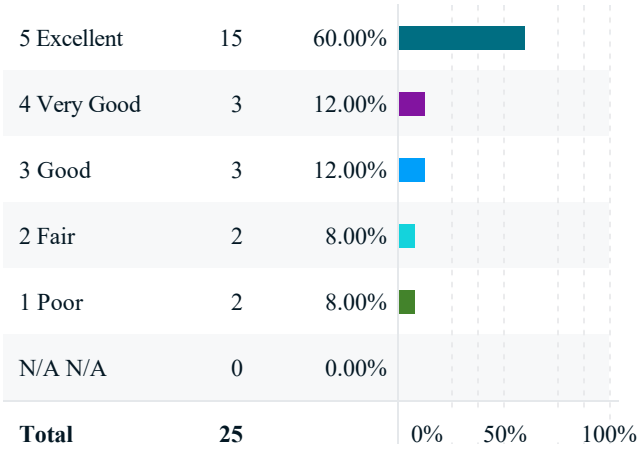
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.68
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.75

3. I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.56
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.77

How would you rate this course overall?



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.08
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.35

Course Specific Open-Ended Responses:

What are the strengths of this course?

Comments
Professor Freund is incredibly passionate about the topics. The presentations are truly interesting and engaging.
Teacher gave a lot of information
Tests are fair examinations of the material provided.
Very well organized and super interesting content. The assignments helped me better understand the material and prepare for the exams.
The ideas of the course are very interesting and the professor is passionate and good at explaining the material and promotes discussion.
Clear explanation
Relevant to real world societal understanding
1) I found the course material just generally very interesting 2) the instructor seemed to really emphasize learning over formalities
The topics we went over were never dull; everything was super interesting.
N/A
math, professor's encouragement, actice lectures (prof asking us the thoughts)
the problem sets are thorough and challenging in a good way, I like how much real world engagement there is as well
This course was intellectual challenging and students were able to grapple real world issues like wealth inequality within and between countries>
– Material was well–organized. – Professor was knowledgeable and passionate about the subject. – Readings that we discussed on Canvas and in class were relevant to the course material and helped me better understand the material.
The prof was a super good lecturer and really attentive to student needs and demands. His in–class examples for more difficult concepts really helped me understand the material, and I definitely improved my self–studying skills to keep up with the course.
I really came to appreciate Professor Freund's approach to complex topics. He did an excellent job of connecting the models to real–world data, explaining what derivations of models mean both mathematically and economically, and always providing alternative perspectives. The problem sets were great practice for the exams.
A lot of real–world applications. Get to learn about the current world, what is going on right now, which is incredibly interesting.
I think the course would have been a lot different if the learning objectives would have been well explained from the start. The class was not what I expected and if I could have turn back time I would have definitely dropped. Did not enjoy class at all and I think that this class would have been way more enjoyable if the class would have actually talked about the inequalities around countries and not about calculus. Class was not good.

What would have improved your learning in the course?

Comments
I would have liked to have a textbook to learn in more detail the concepts and ideas behind the economic models.
Slower pace and less information dense slides
More practice problems or practice tests.
More break down of the maths itself, there are a lot of equations and symbols which initially can be overwhelming so spending more time breaking each factor down.
More TAs
maybe simpler explanations of material
this might be an unreasonable ask, but I sort of expected to walk away with a better idea of: – what policies help reduce inequality? – are these policies actually worth it?
Going over practice problems or examples throughout the slides would be a little helpful at least for me.
N/A
I think it was too fast–paced. The lectures were often hard to understand.
more assignments (small mandatory quizes at home)
honestly more problem sets, they were really helpful in learning the material
Slowing down on the math portions and writing down the math derivations.
I think the course would benefit from more examples in addition to the problem sets of questions similar to the open–ended ones on the exams, as I struggled with these.
In the beginning, the pacing was very quick and there were moments where he assumed we knew things we didn't. That definitely got addressed and improved early on though since he took into account students' feedback.
If I had asked more questions in class about the material when it was unclear in the moment, rather than going home and attempting to figure it out for myself. Additionally, it took me a while to reach out to classmates for help/ to study/ with questions about the class, and I wish I had done so earlier.
There are a lot of models throughout the course, and it's sometimes hard to keep up with what is going on. Could use more explanations for what is happening in the slides.
I think that this class need to be reevaluated. The professor was itself was not the problem, but his tests/work were impossible and ir was really hard to follow along. I did not enjoy this class at all and the course was exaggerxating difficult.

Additional Comments:

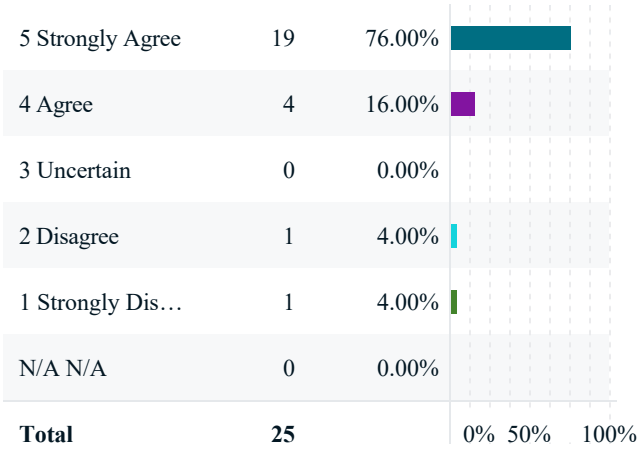
Comments
Professor Freund seems truly accomplished and is motivated in each class. Our guest lecture with Joseph Stiglitz was fascinating.
this might be a failing of my earlier econ courses, but a lot of the course built upon the standard Cobb–Douglass model, and tbh I'm still not fully convinced TFP is a real thing and not just an artifact of a misspecified model
Super fun and challenging course.
N/A
N/A
I was quite intimidated by the questions and the back–and–forths the professor would have with students. I can see it as a strength in the course, however.
Thank you for a great semester! I enjoyed the course material, felt intellectually challenged, and felt as though I grew in my understanding of the material throughout the semester.

Communication Clarity/ Clarity of Instruction:

Instructor Specific Questions for (Lukas Freund)

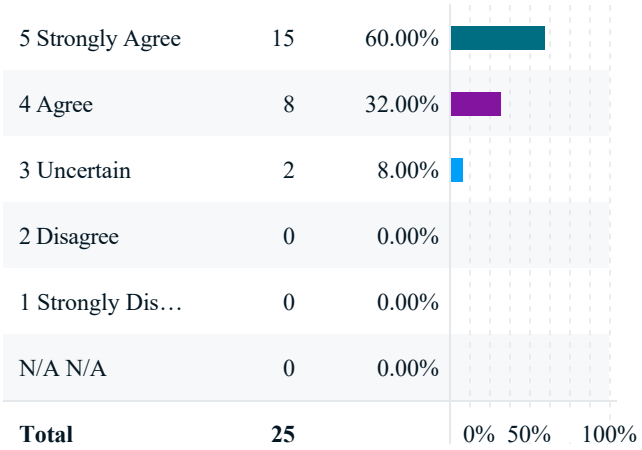
Distribution of Responses

1. The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.



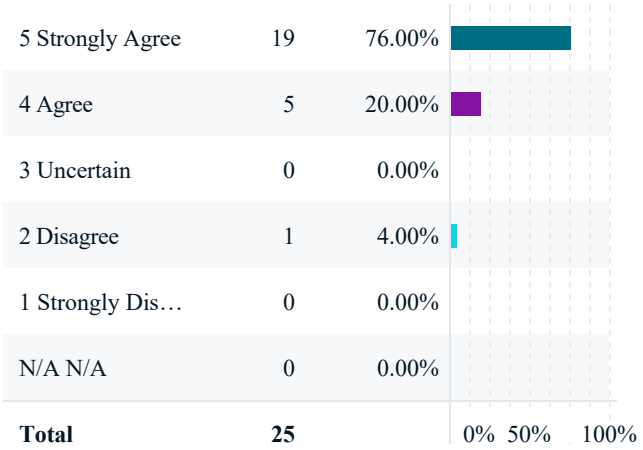
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.56
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.00

2. The instructor was available for help outside of class.



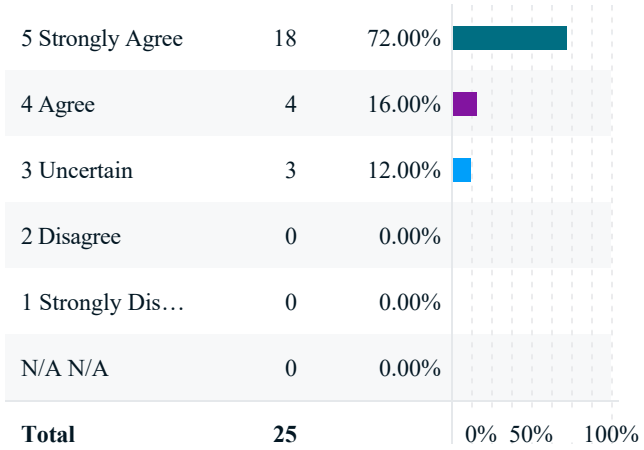
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.52
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.65

3. The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.68
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.69

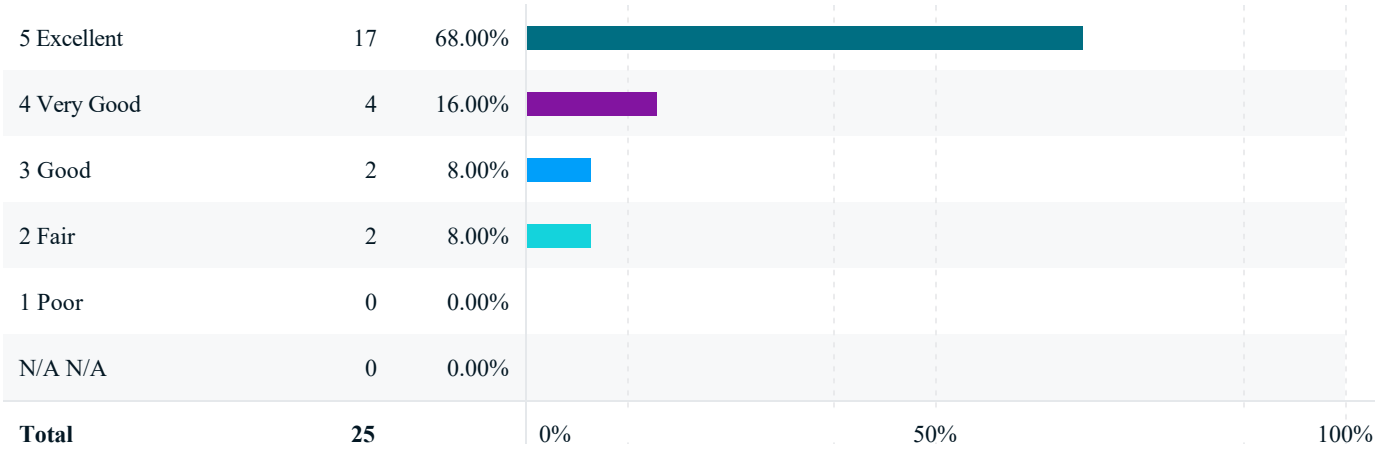
4. The instructor motivated me to do my best work.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.60
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.71

How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?

How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?



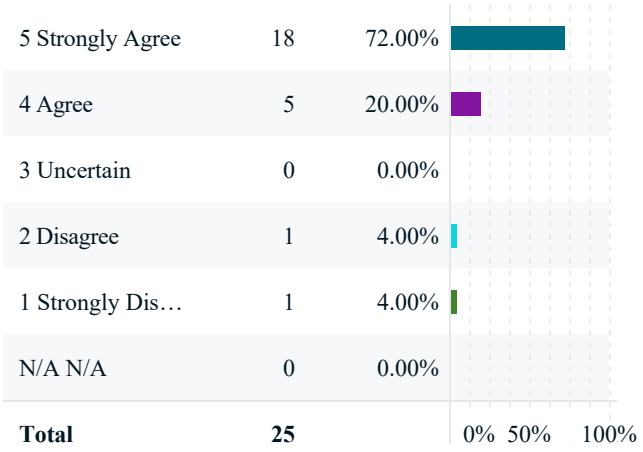
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.44
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.96

Assignments and Grading:

Instructor Specific Questions for (Lukas Freund)

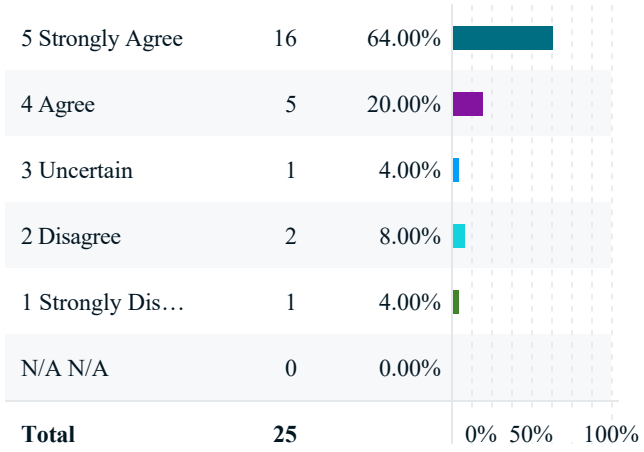
Distribution of Responses

1. I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.52
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.00

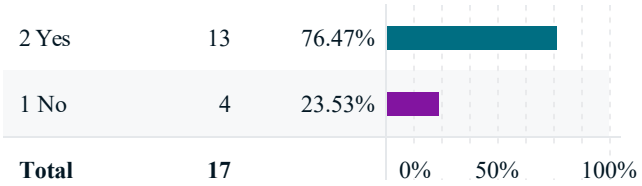
2. I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.32
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.14

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO.

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO.



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	30
Response Count	17
Mean	1.76
Median	2.00
Mode	2

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO. (Comments)

Comment
- There was no required textbook. Although the slides were excellent, I wish a textbook could have given us more insight into each specific topic.
- Yes
- Online resources and readings aided my understanding of the subject matter and provided new perspectives from accredited scholars.
- readings for the course added context to the equations we were looking at
- Good
- Online slides were helpful
- the slides on canvas were quite helpful for review
- N/A
- professor made the best slides to learn from them only!
- the slides being available was very helpful for studying
- There was no required textbook, but the readings we did were very useful in going along with the lectures.
- No textbook! And it was better for it since the lectures were clear and we were given the chance to look at other types of sources to learn economics.
- Outside of class readings were supplemental to my learning, as well as interesting overall (discussions on AI, missing intercept problem, etc)
- The slides and the readings were beneficial.
- This class was horrible and there was nothing that you could be saved for. I studied really hard for my exams and did not get the results I wanted and I could visibly see people taking pictures of the exam amd copying from their phone mid exam which I find as unfair and unacceptable.

Instructor Specific Open-Ended Responses:

Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Comments
Absolutely, he was always polite and encouraging students to participate in class.
Yes
Yes because all students were treated equally.
Yes, this class was interactive, and Prof Freund encouraged active participation.
yes he is very kind and open to talking
Yes
Yes
1000% . he kept the class very objective and welcomed guesses and never made anyone feel belittled
All questions and insights were welcomed and met with supportive feedback.
N/A
yes
100% he leastens to every participator
yes! he was always very friendly and engaging. Its refreshing to have a professor so inclined to have everyone participate
Yes
Yes, he encouraged everyone to ask questions and acknowledged that students have different levels of comfort with participation, so he opened up Canvas discussions on readings as an additional way to participate.
Yes
Never made a student feel bad for an incorrect answer, was always encouraging for 'half correct' responses, overall friendly demeanor.
He is the best Econ professor I've ever had, clear communication and evident interest shown for the students and the subject matter. Clearly a very caring a kind person as well as a great instructor.
Yes, everyone was treated with respect, and the professor tried to give everyone equal opportunities
Yes he did. Personally I think he is a great proffessor and really enthusiastic about his job, but the class was really difficult and not what I expected.

Course Questions for (ECON339701_2025FALL_Macroeconomics of Inequality) - Benchmarks:

Course Organization and Planning/ Course Design:

1. The course was well organized.



2. The learning objectives were clearly defined



The course was intellectually challenging.



On average, how many hours per week outside of class do you devote for this course?



Course Learning Outcomes

1. Class attendance was necessary for learning the course material.



2. Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.



3. I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.



How would your rate this course overall?



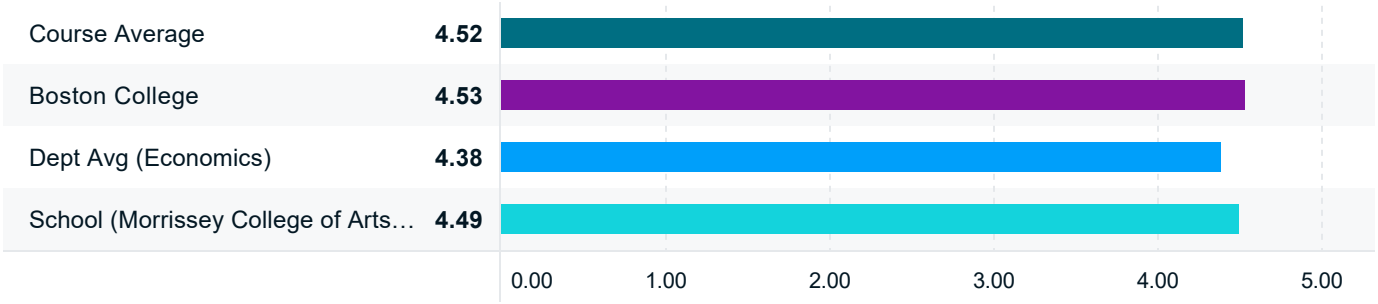
Instructor Questions for (**Lukas Freund**) - Benchmarks:

Communication/ Clarity of Communication/ Faculty/Student Interaction

1. The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.



2. The instructor was available for help outside of class.



3. The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.



4. The instructor motivated me to do my best work.



How would your rate this instructor overall as a teacher? - Benchmarks



Assignnments and Grading

1. I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



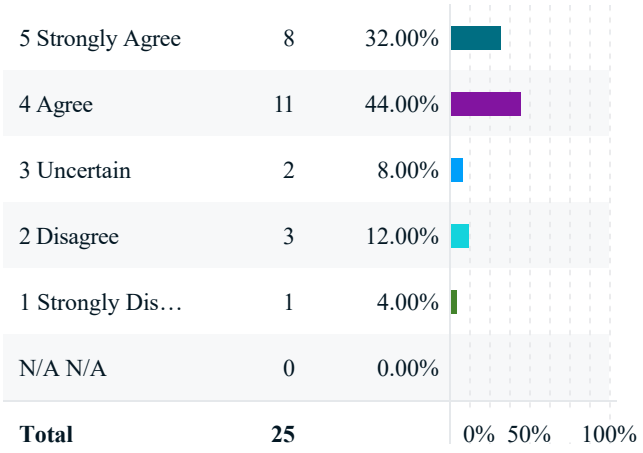
2. I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Responses to Customized Questions for ECON339701_2025FALL_Macroeconomics of Inequality - Lukas Freund

Enter an agreement scale question.

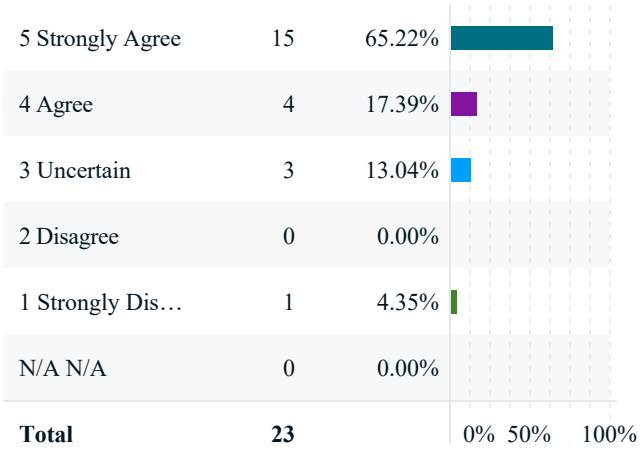
The pace and workload of this course allow me to engage with the material without feeling overwhelmed.



Statistics	Value
Mean	3.88
Median	4.00
Mode	4
Standard Deviation	1.13

Enter an agreement scale question.

The problem sets adequately prepared me for the exams.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.39
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.03

Is there anything else you would like me (the instructor) to know about your experience in this course?

Comments
It was hard
I honestly really enjoyed the course. Some of the derivations could be a bit overwhelming at times, but I think you found a better pace in that regard as the semester went on. I think the way you explain the material is very effective, and I appreciated the way you welcomed interactiveness in a pretty large class (a lot of my other econ classes are not the same way).
I really enjoyed it, personally I would have liked more discussion as opposed to understanding the formulas but that is purely because I'm not very good at maths.
Good
Very helpful slides but maybe better to explain models in simple terms and slower pace
Really enjoyed it. Thank you!
The course went better than expected, super challenging which isn't a bad things, additional practice problems would've been slightly helpful.
N/A
Two things: First, I think it would be helpful if you had a sort of master list with the main formulas and maybe first order conditions. I compiled one for myself, and I found it super helpful, so if you felt so generous to have one of those in the resources, I think that people could benefit from that a lot. Second, I had a really difficult semester academically, my math courses for my other major drained me a lot, and I felt very defeated in all of my classes except yours. Not because it was easy, but because the material was actually relevant and interesting. In addition to that, it was apparent that you care both about the material and about your students. Thank you so much for this class, it made a difference in my life this semester!
– I thought the topics of the course were well–selected since they were extremely interesting and relevant to global economics. – I feel there could have been more material to help us prepare for exams, such as having more extra practice problems outside of just the problem sets and review lecture slides.
I think the class was difficult and had a bit of a learning curve. Still, I found it engaging and the right level of challenging.
Aside from a rough first exam, both given its difficulty and extenuating circumstances, I felt as though I grew a lot throughout the course of the semester. I benefitted from working with classmates on my own time, and felt the course was set up very well.
You're a great professor, the best I've had in Econ at BC.
It was great, learned a lot
Yes, I feel the class has potential but it was really hard to do well. I tried my best and failed miserably every time while others were just cheating mid exam and I can even remember of 1 person who cheated and I saw that person taking pictures of the exam with her phone and for sure dis better than me which I find really unfair.

Which topics/lectures did you find the most interesting?

Comments
Ai
The topic of artificial intelligence and how it impacts labor going forward was especially interesting to me.
I really enjoyed learning about how technology and AI impacts the labor force and inequality because it is such a applicable topic to today's world and the lives of students.
I think the discussions on AI and fiscal vs monetary policy were very interesting
Sbtc
country and wage inequality
the technological change models towards the end
The entire second half of the course was awesome; the first half was also good, but I was super engaged with the second half.
N/A
Task–based model
trivial, but "how AI affects employment/ wage differences etc"
I honestly love the derivation aspect of the class (unpopular opinion), and I found the task based model very interesting
I found the lectures on AI very interesting, as this is something that is very relevant to the modern world, and it was interesting to hear about studies regarding its potential economic impact. I also thought the lectures on global inequality and inequality within the United States were extremely interesting.
I think all of it was super interesting! If I had to choose, I'd say the AI segments were my favorite.
The discussions of automation were probably my favorite topic aside from those on AI. The task–based and canoncial SBTC models and how they explain wage inequality/premia was fascianting, with the impact of AI being most relevant as I move into the work force.
Technology's effect on inequality was most interesting to me as well as AI conversations.
The lectures about AI and job displacement
Nothing, did not enjoy

BOSTON
COLLEGE

Fall 2025

ECON775001_2025FALL_Macroeconomic Theory I - Lukas Freund

Created **Saturday, December 20, 2025**

Fall 2025 Course Evaluation Report for ECON775001_2025FALL_Macroeconomic Theory I - Lukas Freund

Response Table

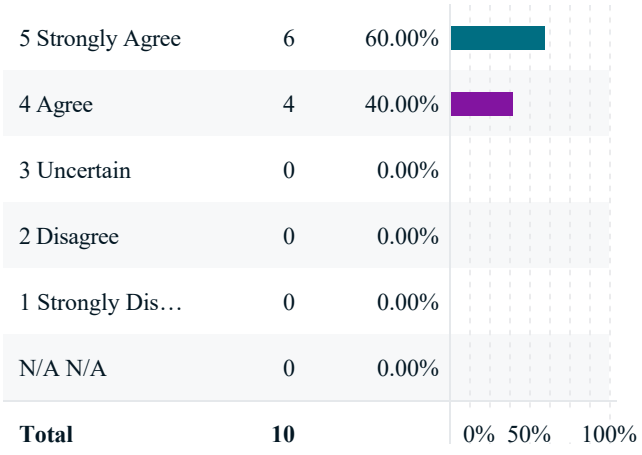
Raters	Students
Responded	10
Invited	11
Response Ratio	90.91%

Course Organization and Planning/ Course Design:

ECON775001_2025FALL_Macroeconomic Theory I

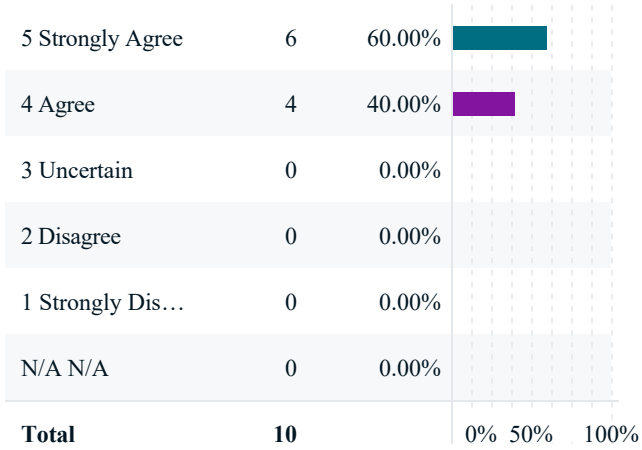
Distribution of Responses

1. The course was well organized.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.60
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.52

2. The learning objectives were clearly defined



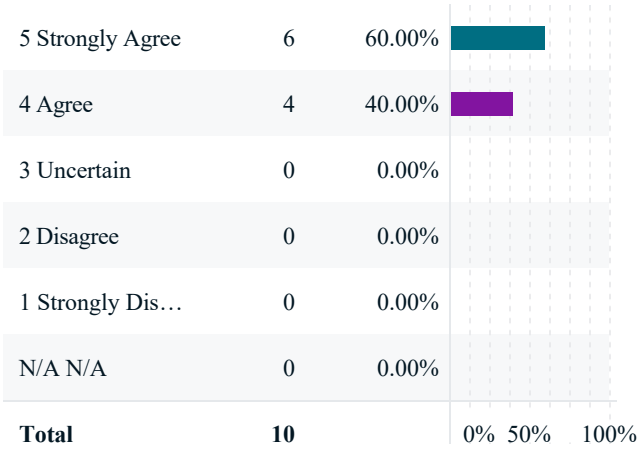
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.60
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.52

Course Difficulty and Workload:

ECON775001_2025FALL_Macroeconomic Theory I

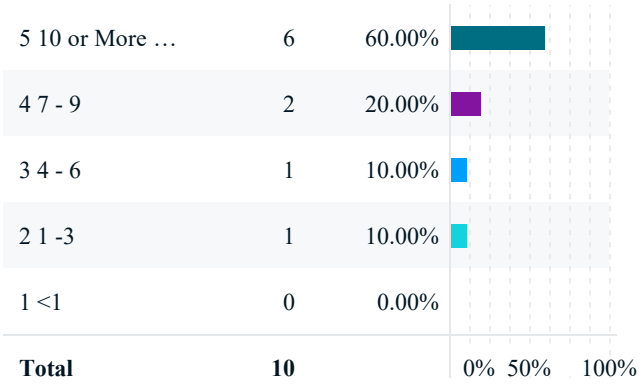
Distribution of Responses

The course was intellectually challenging.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.60
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.52

On average, how many hours per week outside of class do you devote for this course?



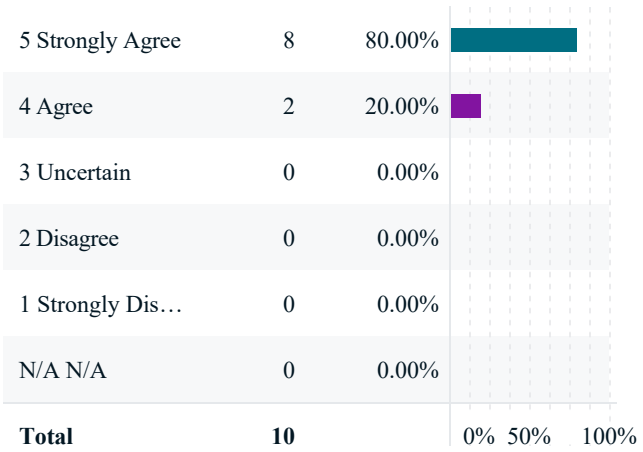
Statistics	Value
Response Count	10
Mean	4.30
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	1.06

Course Learning Outcomes:

ECON775001_2025FALL_Macroeconomic Theory I

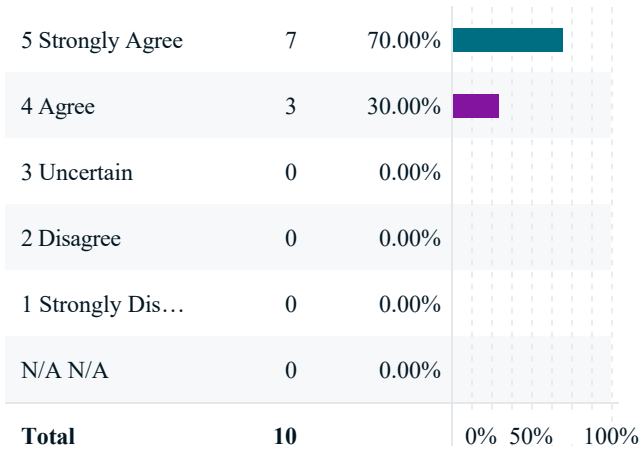
Distribution of Responses

1. Class attendance was necessary for learning the course material.



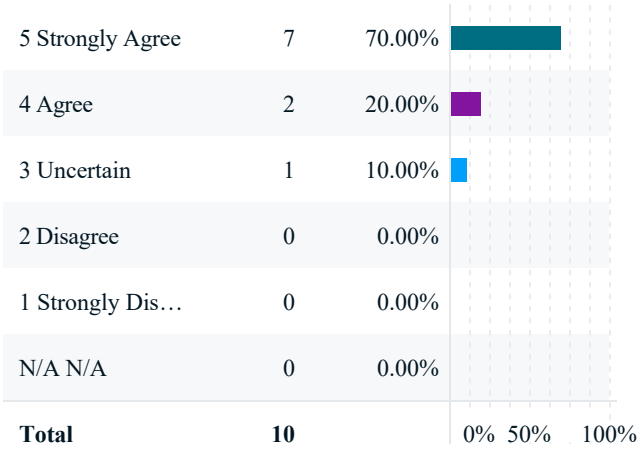
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.80
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.42

2. Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.



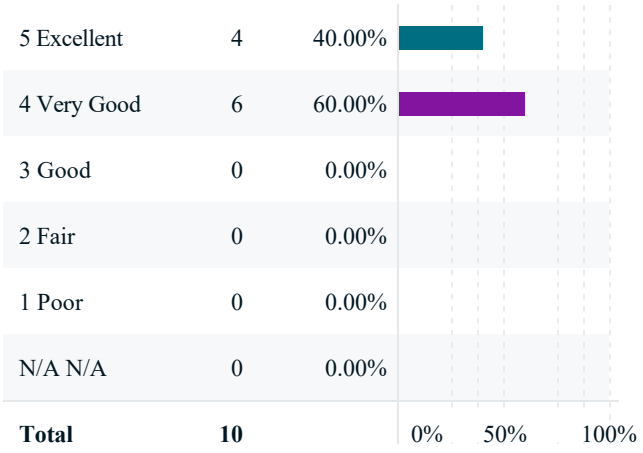
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.70
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.48

3. I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.60
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.70

How would you rate this course overall?



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.40
Median	4.00
Mode	4
Standard Deviation	0.52

Course Specific Open-Ended Responses:

What are the strengths of this course?

Comments
This course helped me solidify my foundation of macroeconomics at the graduate level. It broadened my economic horizons and significantly improved my economic intuition and analytical skills
Well structured, intuitive with a clear goal. Additionally developed programming skills and useful foundation for phd.
Techniques taught in the class are usefull.
The course, especially the second half is very well organised and the material is pretty clear. The first part is fine, but sometimes a bit confusing – like the AK model lacks some key derivation and the implicit motivation on the material.
Learning various topics of Macroeconomics / Instructors' effective explanation
We cover many different areas of macro. Topics are well explained. Lots of opportunities for practice and feedback.
Great course for a foundational understanding of current literature and main macroeconomic models.

What would have improved your learning in the course?

Comments
While I believe the challenging monthly exams will ultimately benefit my future studies, I found the schedule of four exams to be quite demanding.
For both parts, the learning curve is quite steep in the beginning. If more time is given to the professor, I think the introduction can be slower, and more challenging topics and varieties can be discussed later.
We should move the exams to Friday afternoon instead of occupying class time – so there would be another two or three lectures saved. Also, maybe it would be better if more exam–style (or qualifier style) questions are there in the homework. The courses just have too much exams ... (I feel homework should carry a higher weight instead of 0 and the midterm can be slightly lower stake or mainly serves as a "checking point" instead of 40% of the grade ...)
Instructors' effective explanation / Properly assigned problem sets
I think it's unnecessary to have a midterm and a final for each part. One final at the end of each half of the course seems sufficient.
We had too many midterm exams

Additional Comments:

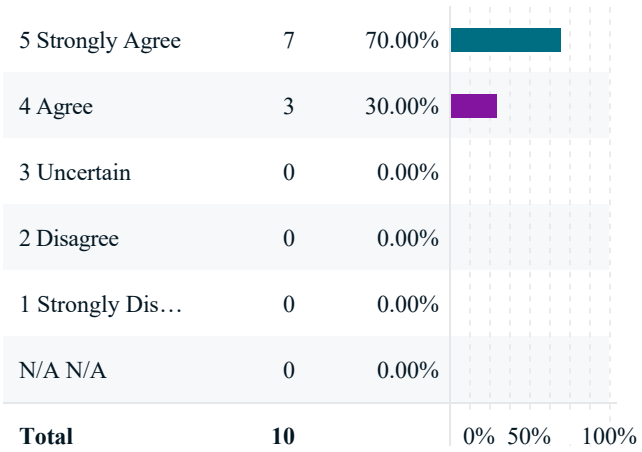
Comments
It is just too much ... Fabio definitely needs another week and two. I feel like the course might be split as Fabio has 2/3 of the semester and Lukas has 1/3 of BOTH semesters (like 4 weeks in each semester) ... (The pacing will be "less rushed" ...)
The material is a little bit too much
Overall positive

Communication Clarity/ Clarity of Instruction:

Instructor Specific Questions for (Lukas Freund)

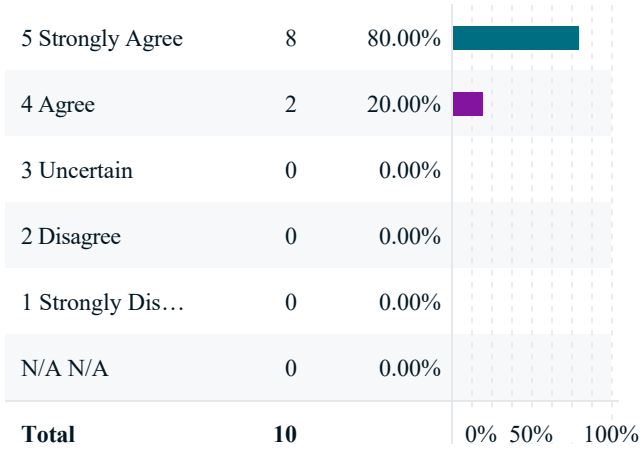
Distribution of Responses

1. The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.



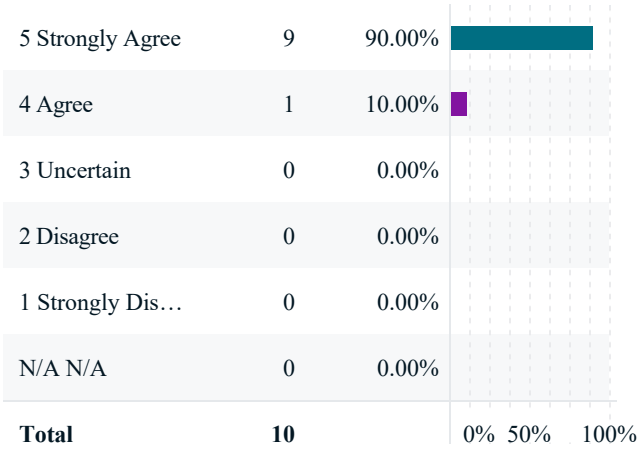
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.70
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.48

2. The instructor was available for help outside of class.



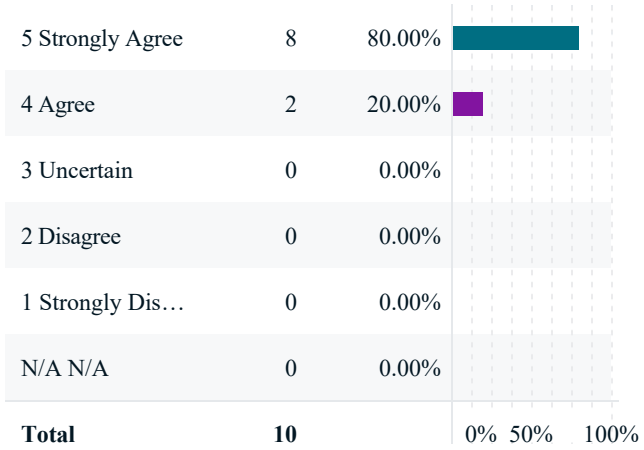
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.80
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.42

3. The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.90
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.32

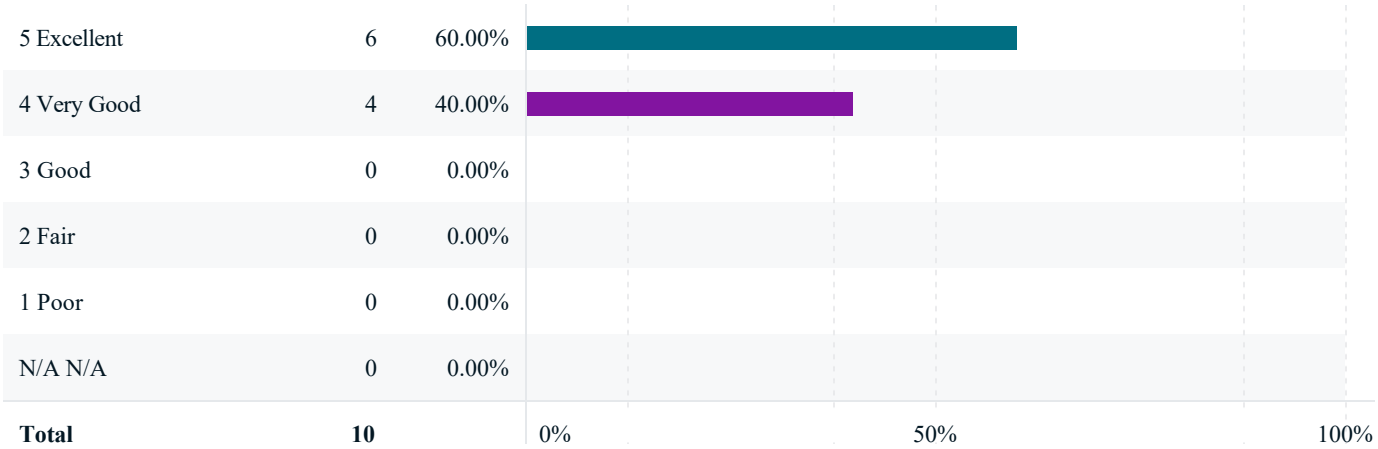
4. The instructor motivated me to do my best work.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.80
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.42

How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?

How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?



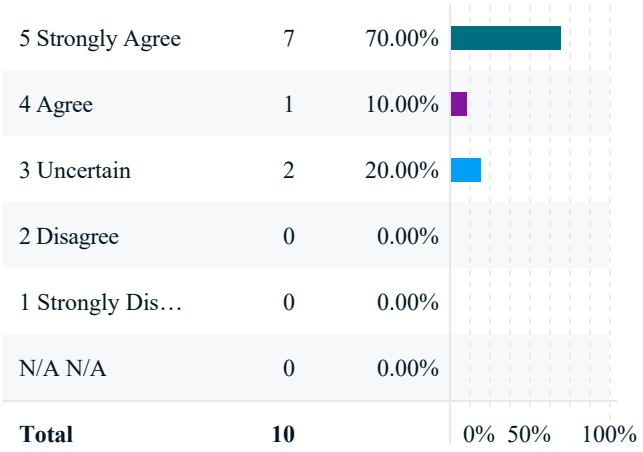
Statistics	Value
Mean	4.60
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.52

Assignments and Grading:

Instructor Specific Questions for (Lukas Freund)

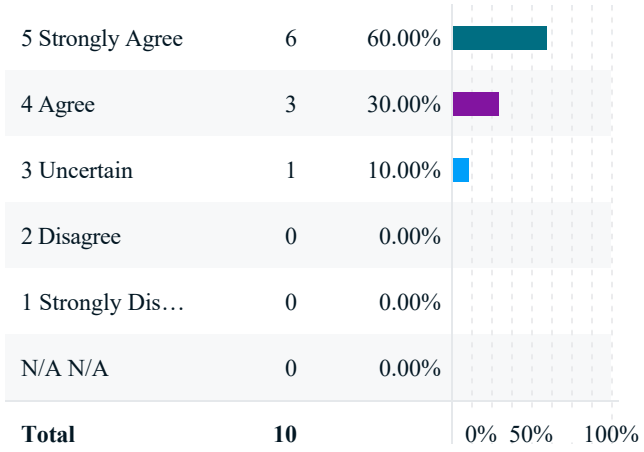
Distribution of Responses

1. I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.50
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.85

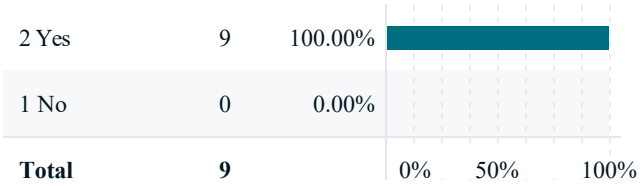
2. I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.50
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.71

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO.

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO.



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	11
Response Count	9
Mean	2.00
Median	2.00
Mode	2

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO. (Comments)

Comment
- At least the PhD macro book is a good starting point to learn the material for the first time, but they don't have exercises (!). I feel Romer is a bit "too untechnical" when dealing with dynamic programming, which fuels lots of confusions. Also, it would be better if you can post the solutions to the exam very soon after the exam so everyone would know the performance beforehand ...
- Materials are helpful.
- Macro textbook provided was great as well as the Slides.

Instructor Specific Open-Ended Responses:

Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Comments
Yes. The professor created a welcoming environment by encouraging students to ask questions. To help clarify confusing topics, the professor uploaded additional reading materials, which helped me understand the motivation behind the concepts. Finally, the additional background slides were helpful.
yes
Yes
Yes. Maybe it would be better if the door is open most of the time (like that of Konishi) so nobody is afraid of jumping in?
Yes. Overall, it was good.
Yes!
Yes

Course Questions for (**ECON775001_2025FALL_Macroeconomic Theory I**) - Benchmarks:

Course Organization and Planning/ Course Design:

1. The course was well organized.



2. The learning objectives were clearly defined



The course was intellectually challenging.



On average, how many hours per week outside of class do you devote for this course?



Course Learning Outcomes

1. Class attendance was necessary for learning the course material.



2. Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.



3. I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.



How would your rate this course overall?



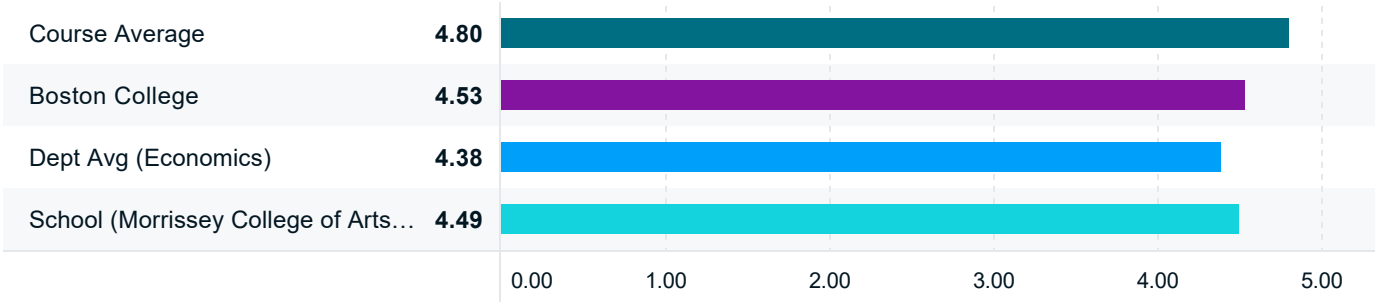
Instructor Questions for (**Lukas Freund**) - Benchmarks:

Communication/ Clarity of Communication/ Faculty/Student Interaction

1. The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.



2. The instructor was available for help outside of class.



3. The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.



4. The instructor motivated me to do my best work.



How would your rate this instructor overall as a teacher? - Benchmarks



Assignnments and Grading

1. I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



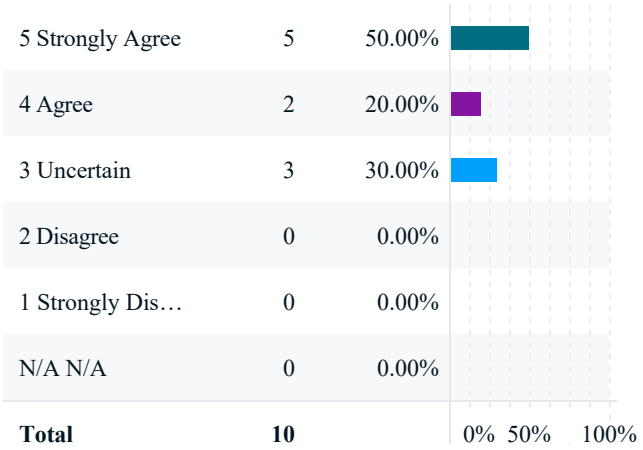
2. I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Responses to Customized Questions for ECON775001_2025FALL_Macroeconomic Theory I - Lukas Freund

Enter an agreement scale question.

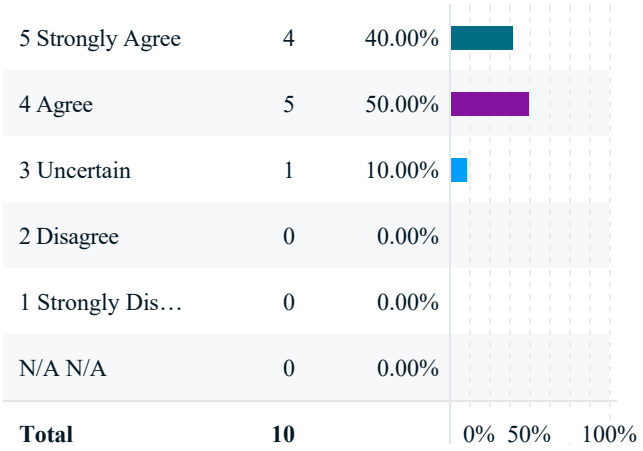
The computational components enhanced my understanding of the subject.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.20
Median	4.50
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.92

Enter an agreement scale question.

The pace of the course was appropriate.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.30
Median	4.00
Mode	4
Standard Deviation	0.67

Where did you struggle most? What could have helped?

Comments
I struggled most with grasping the economic intuition behind the mathematical derivations. Since concepts like "hand–to–mouth" and DMP models were completely new to me, I would have benefited from having additional reading materials on these subjects.
It just feels like my mind just stop working after passing the 60–minute mark and there probably should be slightly more algebraic manipulation for the ease of digestion.
Due to the time limit, assigned lectures for each topic was quite short. Extra problem sets with answers, which are not graded, could have helped me to overcome the problem (unlike regular(?) problem sets, I think answers for extra ones would be provided simultaneously).
Programming was hard to follow completely due to time constraints, did not have much time to fully grasp how the methodologies could be applied and their effects on results.

Any other comments on course materials, problem sets, or exams?

Comments
The course materials were very effective. While they were quite challenging, I appreciated the opportunity to encounter new topics and expand my knowledge. The problem set solutions were helpful for reinforcing my understanding of the concepts, such as the stationary distribution in the Aiyagari model. However, I felt the problem sets before the midterm were easier than the exam itself. In contrast, the later problem sets were much better aligned with the exams and were very useful for preparation.
maybe 4 exams of the course could be compressed in 2. Otherwise, everything was fine.
There should be more lectures ... (like all exams should be put into Friday afternoon).
Overall positive
While I recognize how important computational methods are in modern macroeconomics, given the structure of the course and the amount of material we needed to digest, they seemed more of a distraction. Perhaps one computational exercise is sufficient to get an idea of how these methods work with an understanding that we will be doing much more computational work if we decide to do macro as our field of research.
Not in particular.
I think that having an exam every 2/3 weeks doesn't help. We could have used those hours to cover additional material instead. Or to go deeper in some topics.

BOSTON
COLLEGE

Fall 2025

ECON886201_2025FALL_Monetary Economics II - Lukas Freund

Created **Saturday, December 20, 2025**

Fall 2025 Course Evaluation Report for ECON886201_2025FALL_Monetary Economics II - Lukas Freund

Response Table

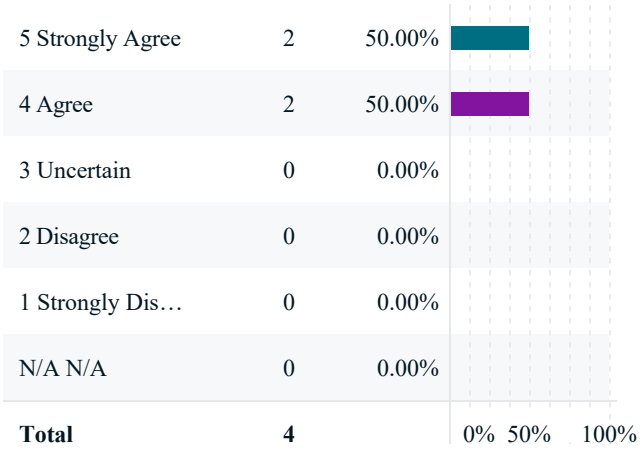
Raters	Students
Responded	4
Invited	5
Response Ratio	80%

Course Organization and Planning/ Course Design:

ECON886201_2025FALL_Monetary Economics II

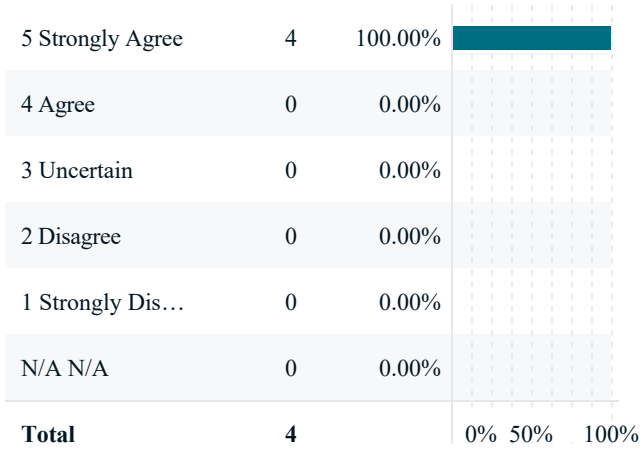
Distribution of Responses

1. The course was well organized.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.50
Median	4.50
Mode	5, 4
Standard Deviation	0.58

2. The learning objectives were clearly defined



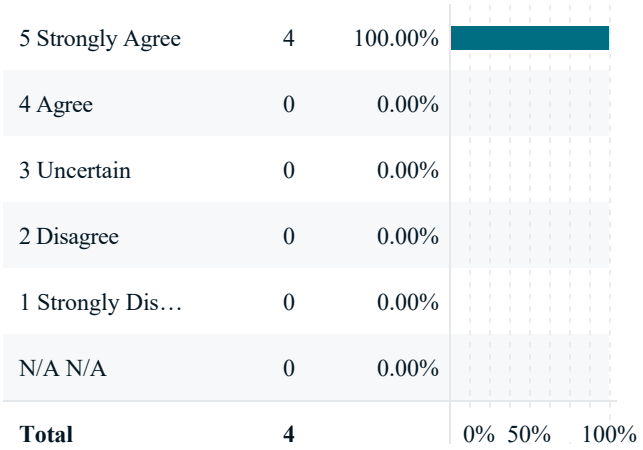
Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

Course Difficulty and Workload:

ECON886201_2025FALL_Monetary Economics II

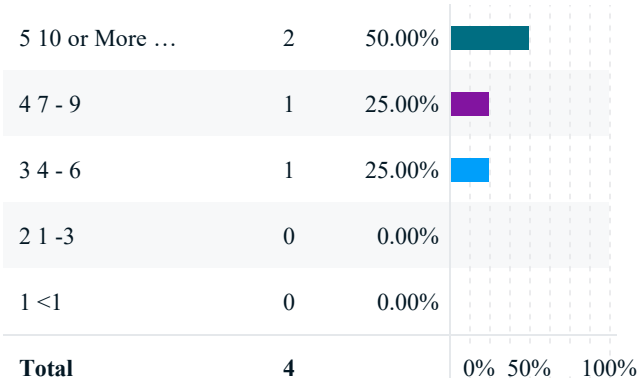
Distribution of Responses

The course was intellectually challenging.



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

On average, how many hours per week outside of class do you devote for this course?



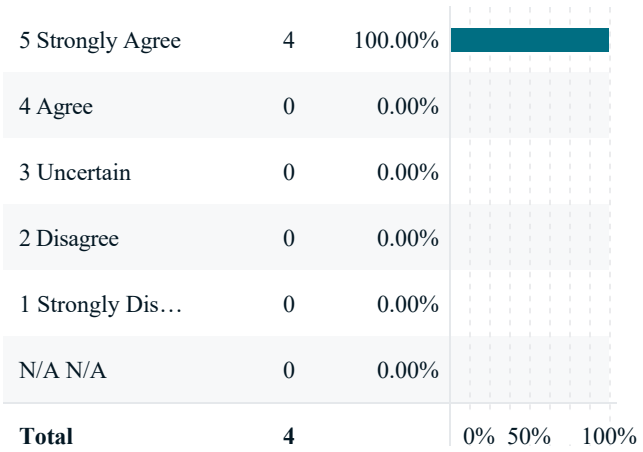
Statistics	Value
Response Count	4
Mean	4.25
Median	4.50
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.96

Course Learning Outcomes:

ECON886201_2025FALL_Monetary Economics II

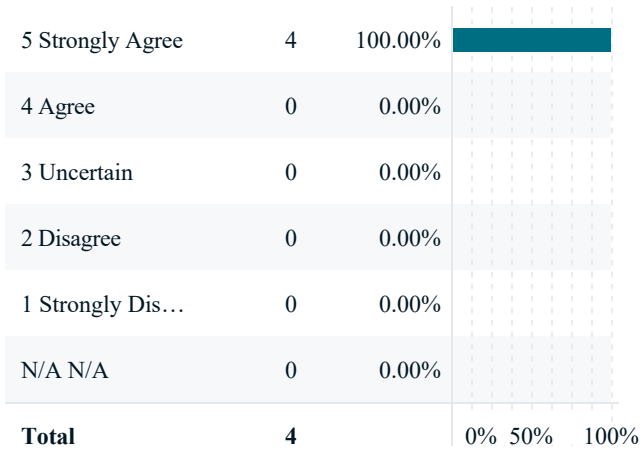
Distribution of Responses

1. Class attendance was necessary for learning the course material.



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

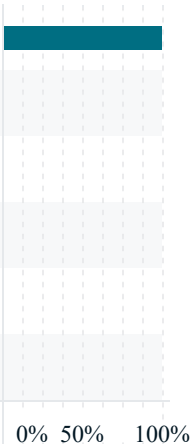
2. Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

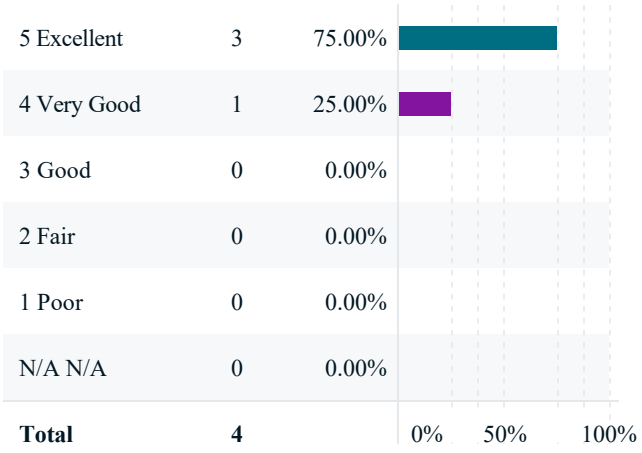
3. I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.

5 Strongly Agree	4	100.00%
4 Agree	0	0.00%
3 Uncertain	0	0.00%
2 Disagree	0	0.00%
1 Strongly Dis…	0	0.00%
N/A N/A	0	0.00%
Total	**4**	



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

How would you rate this course overall?



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.75
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.50

Course Specific Open-Ended Responses:

What are the strengths of this course?

Comments
New Material on Heterogeneous Firm
In my opinion the assignments are all very well suited to prepare us beyond the class, as active researchers and not only consumers of the literature
Interesting topics, with a good mix of fundamentals and frontier research.
Both instructors are extremely good and give very useful tips on how to engage the cutting edge literature on firm heterogeneity

What would have improved your learning in the course?

Comments
Maybe having the class over the whole semester, to have more time to deepen the material and the proposal
Correct the grammar: A couple of coding sessions to understand better how to implement the material seen in class
Maybe it can be useful to have as assignment a Referee report. The assignments we had were helpful, I would just add this other one. It can help even more engaging with the literature

Additional Comments:

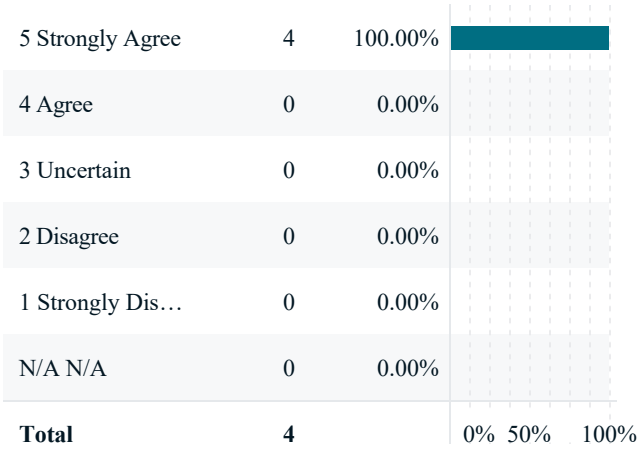
Comments
For me this class was very interesting and it was a great learning experience

Communication Clarity/ Clarity of Instruction:

Instructor Specific Questions for (Lukas Freund)

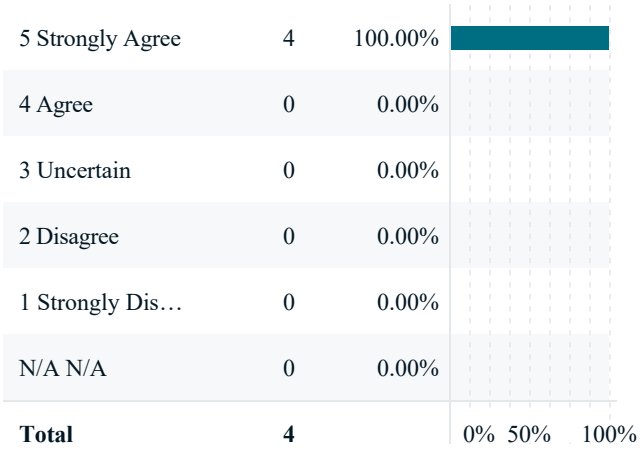
Distribution of Responses

1. The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.



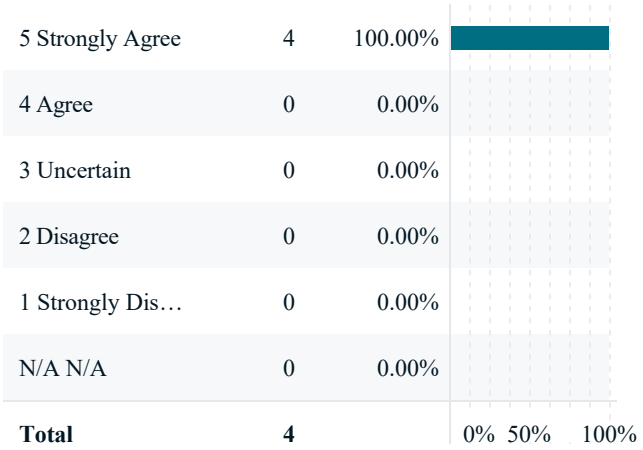
Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

2. The instructor was available for help outside of class.



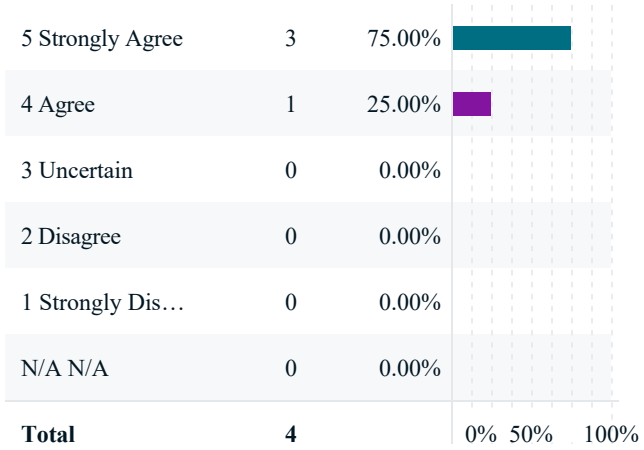
Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

3. The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

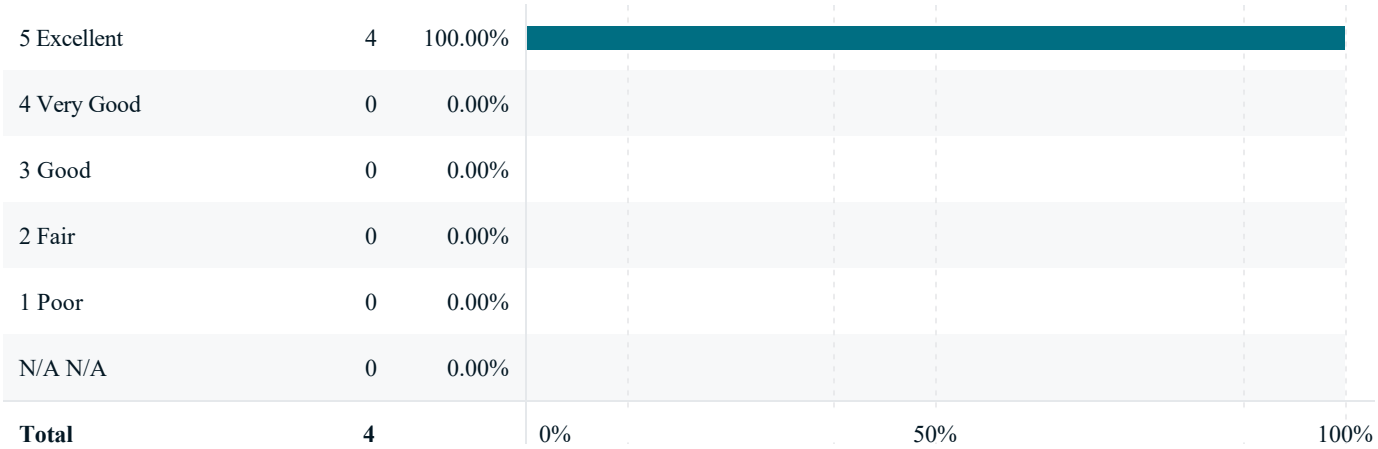
4. The instructor motivated me to do my best work.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.75
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.50

How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?

How would you rate this instructor overall as a teacher?



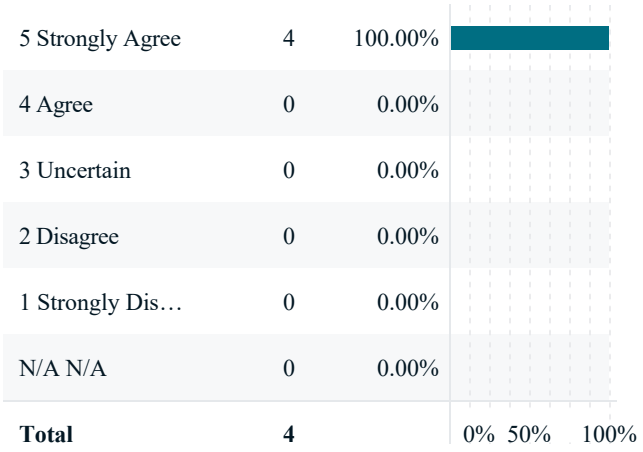
Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

Assignments and Grading:

Instructor Specific Questions for (Lukas Freund)

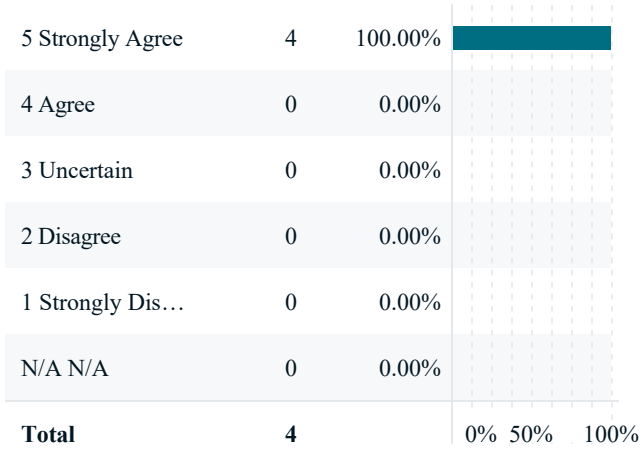
Distribution of Responses

1. I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

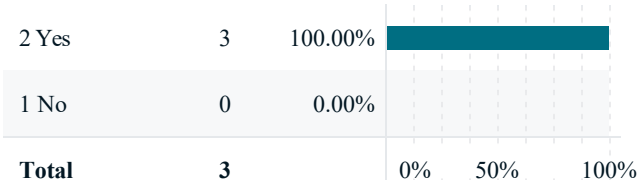
2. I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Mode	5
Standard Deviation	0.00

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO.

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO.



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	5
Response Count	3
Mean	2.00
Median	2.00
Mode	2

Did you find the required course materials (e.g., textbook(s), coursepack(s), online resources, etc.) helpful in your learning the subject matter? YES/NO. (Comments)

Comment
- Yes, a lot of interesting and useful papers about the topics were suggested
- Slides, codes, and tips were all crucial for my preparation. I would maybe add a slide at the end of each slide set with food for thoughts, adding useful reference to go beyond the scope of the course. It's not a huge miss, it's just something I like to go back to.

Instructor Specific Open-Ended Responses:

Did the instructor treat all students with respect, and cultivate an open and welcoming environment in class? How or how not?

Comments
Yes, the instructor created a very good and engaging learning environment, encouraging participation in class
The instructor created a respectful environment were it was possible to share feedbacks

Course Questions for (ECON886201_2025FALL_Monetary Economics II) - Benchmarks:

Course Organization and Planning/ Course Design:

1. The course was well organized.



2. The learning objectives were clearly defined



The course was intellectually challenging.



On average, how many hours per week outside of class do you devote for this course?



Course Learning Outcomes

1. Class attendance was necessary for learning the course material.



2. Assignments were helpful in learning the course material.



3. I learned perspectives, principles or practices that I expect to apply beyond the course.



How would your rate this course overall?



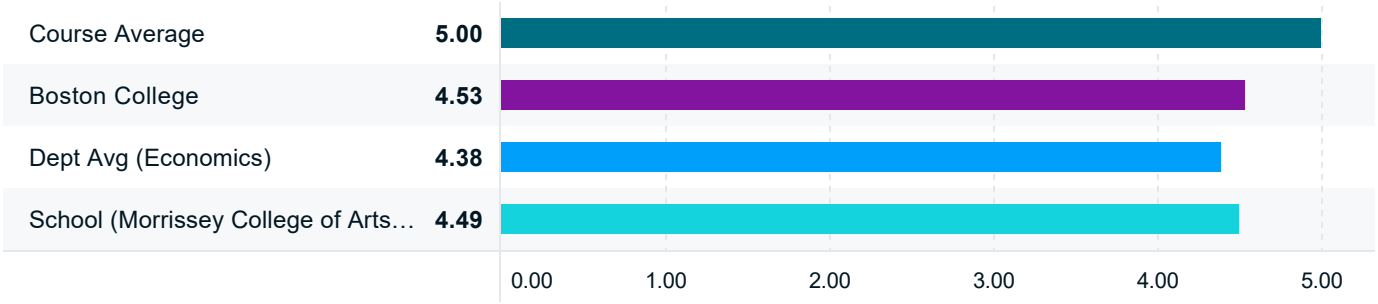
Instructor Questions for (**Lukas Freund**) - Benchmarks:

Communication/ Clarity of Communication/ Faculty/Student Interaction

1. The instructor was effective in helping students understand difficult concepts, methods, and subject matter.



2. The instructor was available for help outside of class.



3. The instructor stimulated interest in the subject matter.



4. The instructor motivated me to do my best work.



How would your rate this instructor overall as a teacher? - Benchmarks



Assignnments and Grading

1. I received timely feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



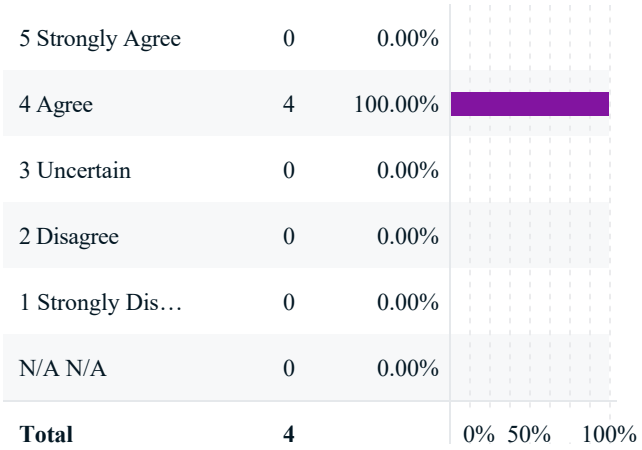
2. I received meaningful feedback on my assignments and assessments (tests).



Responses to Customized Questions for ECON886201_2025FALL_Monetary Economics II - Lukas Freund

Enter an agreement scale question.

The pace and workload of this course allow me to engage with the material without feeling overwhelmed.



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.00
Median	4.00
Mode	4
Standard Deviation	0.00

Is there anything else you would like me (the instructor) to know about your experience in this course?

Comments
The course was intense, but when I was referring to the pace before, I wasn't meaning that the course was overwhelming

Part II: University of Cambridge

Undergraduate supervisions during my PhD, 2018–2020

Small-group supervisions in second-year undergraduate macroeconomics. Each letter from Directors of Studies reports student evaluation scores and comments.

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Letter from the Director of Studies in Economics, Christ's College (2018–19)	80
Letter from two Directors of Studies in Economics (2019–20)	82

From Dr Julia Shvets
CHRIST'S COLLEGE, CAMBRIDGE CB2 3BU

October 27, 2019

Dear Sir or Madam

I am writing in my capacity as Director of Studies in Economics at Christ's. During 2018-2019 academic year, Lukas Freund supervised Macroeconomics for our seven second year undergraduates. He did a superb job, as testified by the evaluations below.

Evaluation 1. Anonymous student survey.
Lukas Freund only taught supervisions, which accompany the lectures for this course, given by the Faculty of Economics lecturers. Hence, question 4 is not evaluating Lukas Freund's teaching but instead was included for background.

Number of respondents: 6 (total number in the group: 7)					
	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree	Strongly agree
1. The supervisor is well prepared	0%	0%	0%	0%	100%
2. The supervisor is enthusiastic about what he/ she is teaching	0%	0%	0%	0%	100%
3. The supervisor is good at explaining things	0%	0%	0%	50%	50%
4. The lectures for this paper were of high quality	0%	16.67%	16.67%	66.67%	0%

Comments added by the students:

- Very passionate teacher who cares a lot and goes the extra mile. But may have a tendency to over complicate things.
- Lukas was an extremely enthusiastic supervisor who was incredibly helpful throughout the term. His supervisions were detailed, interesting, and informative, whilst helping to see how a concept fits into the bigger picture of the world of economics, which is very helpful to consider and is rarely present in lectures. Lukas was also very friendly and connected with students well, allowing us to express concerns which we may not always be able to with other supervisors. Lukas was also extremely proactive in taking feedback from students. Sometimes, the math to get to a solution could be difficult, and when we expressed that it

would be helpful to go through the mathematics further, Lukas ensured that enough time was spent to make sure that we understood the solution fully, showing his excellent response to student's needs. Overall, Lukas has been a fantastic supervisor.

- Lukas Freund was one of the best supervisors I have had throughout my Cambridge experience and has greatly motivated me
- I hope you supervise Macro IIA next year so the year under can get the same quality teaching as our year!

Evaluation 2. Comments on the general form submitted to Christ's Senior Tutor. The form asks a number of general questions about the students' learning experience. Only one question asks about individual supervisors and I've included it below. The question does not refer to any particular supervisors and the students are not required to fill it in — hence many leave it blank.

Question: Are there any specific comments you wish to make, for example in regard to supervisions in particular subject areas, or setting/marking of any written work? *(Please mention any supervisors who have been especially helpful, in addition to any with whom there may have been problems)*

Answer 1: Lukas Freund was an excellent (twice underlined) supervisor!! He gave detailed and specific feedback; He focussed supervisions on areas we were weaker in; He focussed on the small and big picture so we knew how what we were learning fit in with the rest of theory.

Answer 2: Lukas Freund is amazing!

Please do not hesitate to contact me if I can provide any more information.

Sincerely



Dr Julia Shvets
Senior college lecturer

UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE
Faculty of Economics

6 July 2020

Dear Selection Committee,

Teaching Evaluations – Lukas Freund

We are delighted to write to recommend the teaching abilities of Lukas Freund. We know Lukas in our capacity as Directors of Studies in Economics at the University of Cambridge, where we are responsible for the academic progress of students under our direction. We both direct studies for students who have been taught second-year macroeconomics by Lukas. The course covers intertemporal macroeconomics, unemployment, monetary economics and international economics.

Teaching is in the form of eight small-group classes (group size ~3-4, classes are called "supervisions"). Supervisions cover problem sets which are submitted and marked in advance, plus a revision session based on a mock exam that Lukas has drawn up from scratch. Lukas also added a collaborative literature review, in which students were each assigned a key paper from the course and told to present it to the group. Students also provided a structured summary of the paper that Lukas complied into an anthology. This is additional to the standard teaching programme but makes a very valuable addition to students' skills. The skills developed are of the sort which can be overlooked. It also shows Lukas's commitment to going beyond his duties to ensure the students get a good education.

Lukas is one of our most popular supervisors. His students value both his excellent teaching abilities, but also his kindness and willingness to help them learn. Our students have nothing but praise for Lukas's supervisions, and they are certainly not shy when it comes to expressing dissatisfaction. In particular, Lukas's students praise his careful and detailed comments and feedback on their work and the clarity of his explanations. They say that Lukas has high standards for them and appreciate his efforts to push them to constantly improve. Lukas adapted seamlessly to moving to remote teaching as required by the coronavirus pandemic.

Students fill in a questionnaire regarding their satisfaction with supervision arrangements. Lukas's scores are close to perfect. We enclose a summary of Lukas's scores below. Please note the scoring scheme: 1 = seriously deficient, 2 = deficient, 3 = acceptable, 4 = good, 5 = excellent.

How good is your supervisor at…	Mean	N
Explaining those parts of the course with which you need most help?	4.67	12
Expanding your knowledge beyond the lectures?	4.75	12
Giving feedback on your written work?	4.67	12
Giving encouragement?	4.50	12

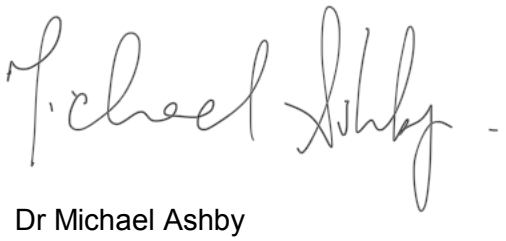
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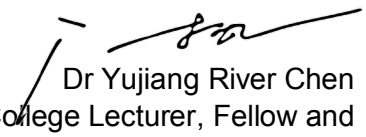
Below, we provide some testimonials collected via our usual feedback collection mechanisms:

Lukas is incredibly dedicated towards his students, not only caring for our well-being but also providing very detailed, tailored feedback in our work, an example of this is how he provides an extensive general supervision feedback report for every supervision on top of the individual feedback on your submitted work. His supervisions are very structured, always challenging our deeper understanding of the material and theory used in the questions, and Lukas also never fails to add extra details beyond the syllabus with enthusiasm which makes the learning experience rewarding and enjoyable – I remember after supervisions talking with other attendees about how clear and concise he explained concepts we were previously muddled by.
Lukas has been one of the best supervisors I've had this year. Throughout, Lukas has been incredibly encouraging and always goes the extra mile to make sure we are up to speed with the material. Lukas is extremely dedicated to his teaching and often challenges us to engage with the material on a deeper level. The macro syllabus was, for me at least, the most difficult paper this year but having Lukas as a supervisor really helped.
Lukas Freund puts in a lot more time and effort than the average supervisor. He arranged for us to do a collaborative literature review and he also wrote his own mock exam for us to do.

Yours sincerely,



Dr Michael Ashby
Williams-Downing Fellow and
Director of Studies in Economics,
Downing College in the University of Cambridge



Dr Yujiang River Chen
Bevil Mabey College Lecturer, Fellow and
Director of Studies in Economics,
St Catharine's College in the University of Cambridge